# Cristian Lara

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## EDUCATION

**Stanford University** — Stanford, CA
*B.S. in Computer Science* — *2014 – 2018*

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Meta** — New York, NY
*Software Engineer* — *June 2024 – May 2026*

Core contributor to primary UI for Meta's internal Ax experimentation platform for state-of-the-art black-box bayesian optimization. Worked closely with research scientists to productionize novel methods in experimentation for both offline (automl) and online (a/b testing) use cases (Research Paper).

**Application Redesign**

- Spearheaded the end-to-end redesign of the Ax experimentation UI, introducing new lifecycle tracking, improved navigation, and enhanced user experience.
- Delivered features such as experiment cloning, transfer learning integration, and advanced trial management, resulting in increased adoption and improved experimentation outcomes.

**Open Source Excellence**

- Upgraded Ax and BoTorch open-source documentation infrastructure (Docusaurus, Sphinx, ReadTheDocs)
- Fixed critical build and deployment issues, and synchronized cross-repo improvements.
- Enhanced onboarding and developer experience by improving docs, CI workflows, and automating versioning.

**Angaza** — San Francisco, CA
*Senior Software Engineer* — *Jan 2022 – July 2023*
*Software Engineer* — *July 2018 – Jan 2022*

Owned and contributed to major projects involving building performant architecture using AWS with Terraform, scalable databases in Postgres, robust APIs in Python, web applications in ReactJS, and more.

**Application Redesign**

- Led a major 9-month project to overhaul the design of our entire frontend web application, resulting in a new component design system for more efficient frontend development and modern UX for improved customer sentiment.
- Onboarded and managed a team of engineering contractors to rapidly implement technical deliverables.
- Collaborated with product and design teams as lead technical advisor to manage scope and determine project roadmap.

**Bulk SMS Campaigns**

- Designed and implemented scalable infrastructure to support a platform for large SMS Campaigns.
- Built on Celery +RabbitMQ for a publish/subscriber event model.
- Infrastructure handles over 100 million SMS per year.

## PROJECTS

**Stanford Pokemon** (github.com/CristianLara/stanford-pokemon)

Stanford-themed Pokemon game engine implemented entirely from scratch using React.

**Personal Website** (github.com/CristianLara/cristianlara.github.io)

Interactive terminal to learn more about me built entirely from scratch using plain Javascript with no dependencies.

## ADDITIONAL

**LANGUAGES:** English (native), Spanish (native), Turkish (proficient), Mandarin (basic)
**TECHNICAL SKILLS:** Python, Javascript, Java, C++; ReactJS, Redux, Webpack, Flask, Nginx, Postgres, AWS, Terraform
**INTERESTS:** Competitive Gaming, Photography, Keyboards, Cycling, Formula 1, Arduino + RPi, Ping Pong